# Auto-Motion App

## User Manual

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## Table of Contents

1. Overview
2. Getting Started
3. Settings
4. Project Template
5. Metadata Management
6. Append Clips to Timeline
7. Script Descriptions
8. Prerequisites & Requirements
9. Troubleshooting
10. Guidelines
11. Support Team

# 1. Overview

Welcome to the Auto-Motion App, a handy desktop tool designed to make your production workflow smoother and more consistent. We've built this app to cut down on repetitive manual tasks and help standardise your post-production process.

Here's what our toolkit offers:

- Create and manage project templates with ease
- Handle clip and timeline metadata in bulk
- Automatically add clips to timelines without the tedious manual work
- Set up standardised folder structures in seconds

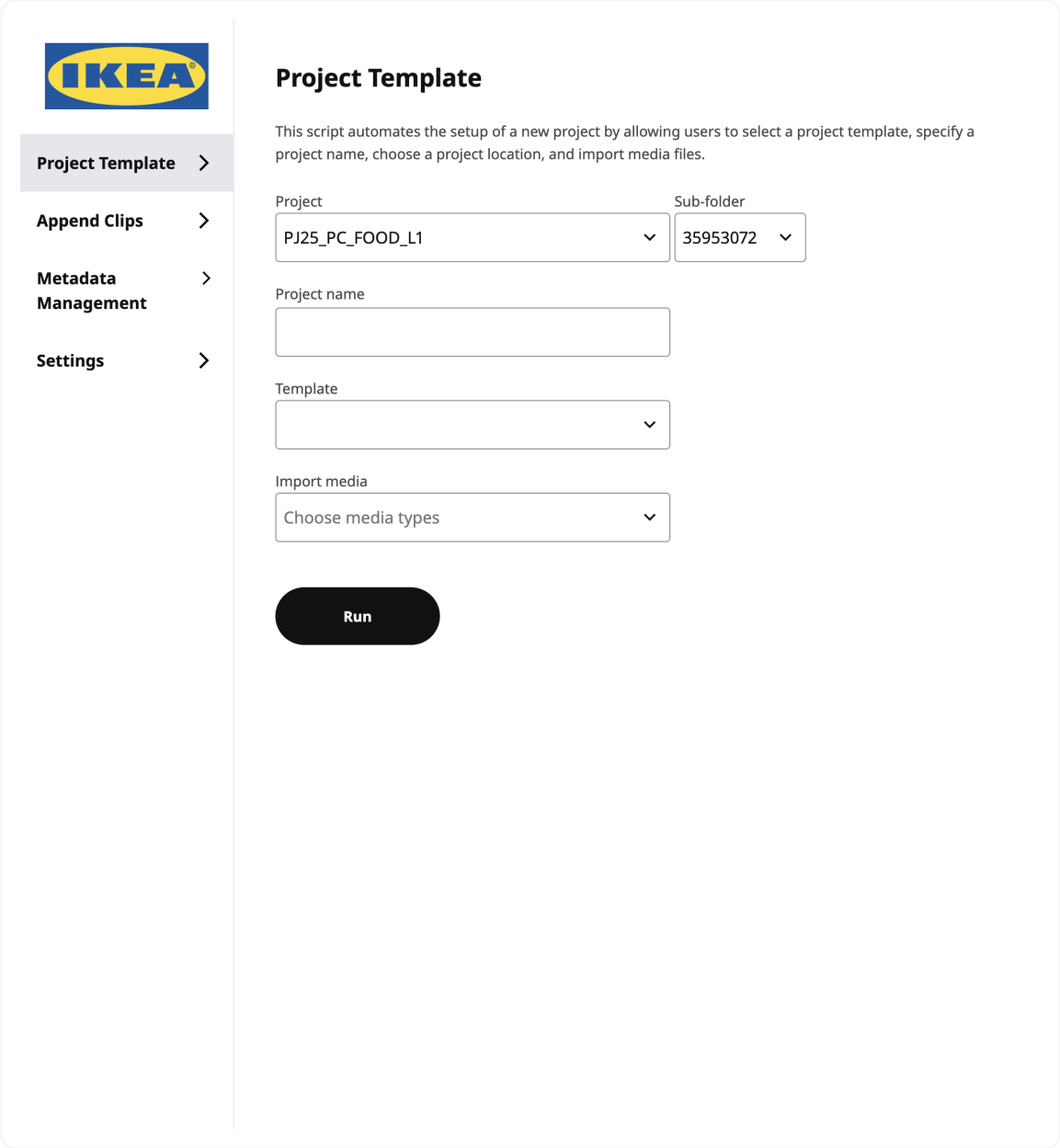
# 2. Getting Started

Before diving into the Auto-Motion App, make sure you've got:

- DaVinci Resolve installed on your computer
- DaVinci Resolve open and running, with your preferred database and project libraries location selected

> **Important:** Our app talks to DaVinci Resolve through its API. For most features to work properly, you'll need to have DaVinci Resolve running in the background.

When you first open the app, you'll see a clean interface with a navigation menu on the left and your working area on the right. Simply click on any tool in the sidebar to get started.



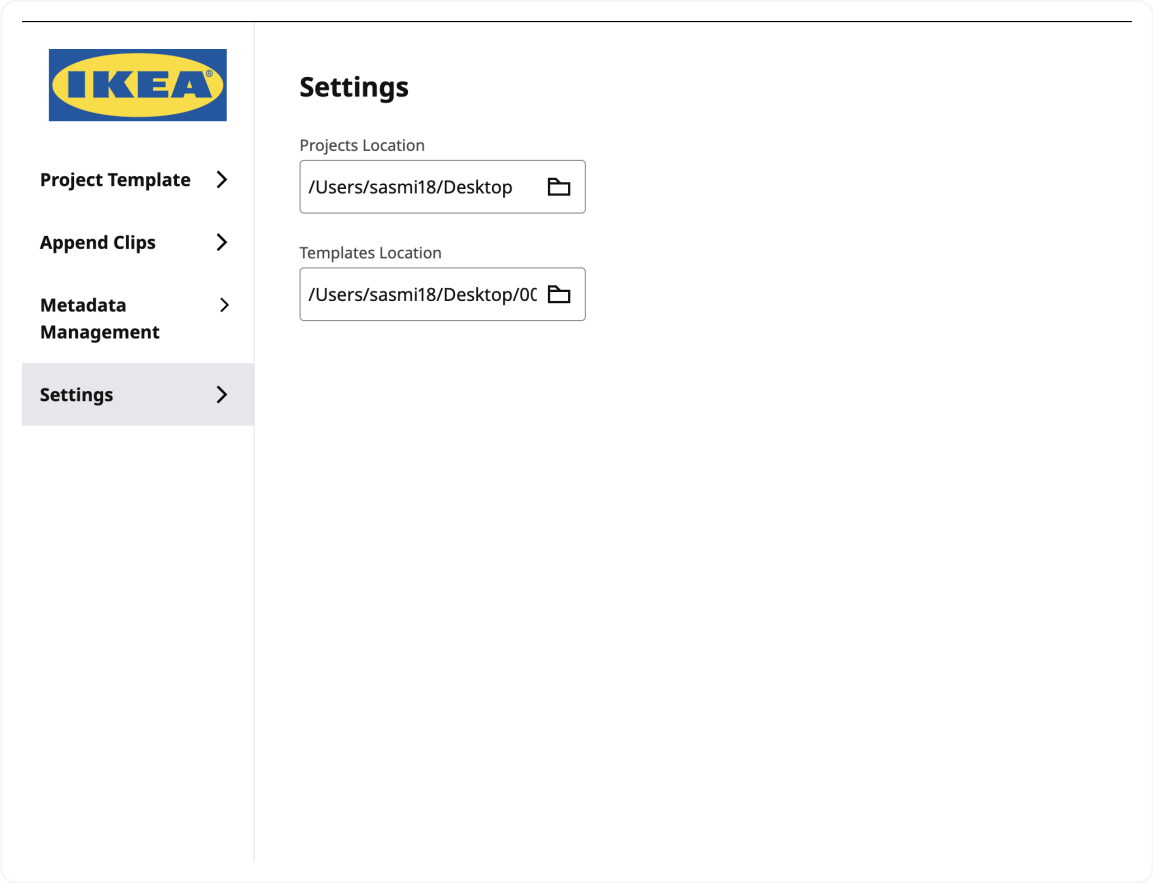
# 3. Settings

The Settings page is where you'll set up the essential paths that the app needs to work with your projects.

> **Step 1: Choose Your Project Location**
>
> Click the "Browse" button next to "Projects Location" to select the main folder where you want to store all your projects. This is an important setting as all other tools will use this location as their starting point.

> **Step 2: Set Up Your Templates Location**
>
> The app will automatically look for templates in the standard DaVinci Resolve template folders. If you keep your templates somewhere else, you can point the app to that location here.

> Don't worry about saving your settings - the app remembers them automatically for the next time you open it.




# 4. Project Template

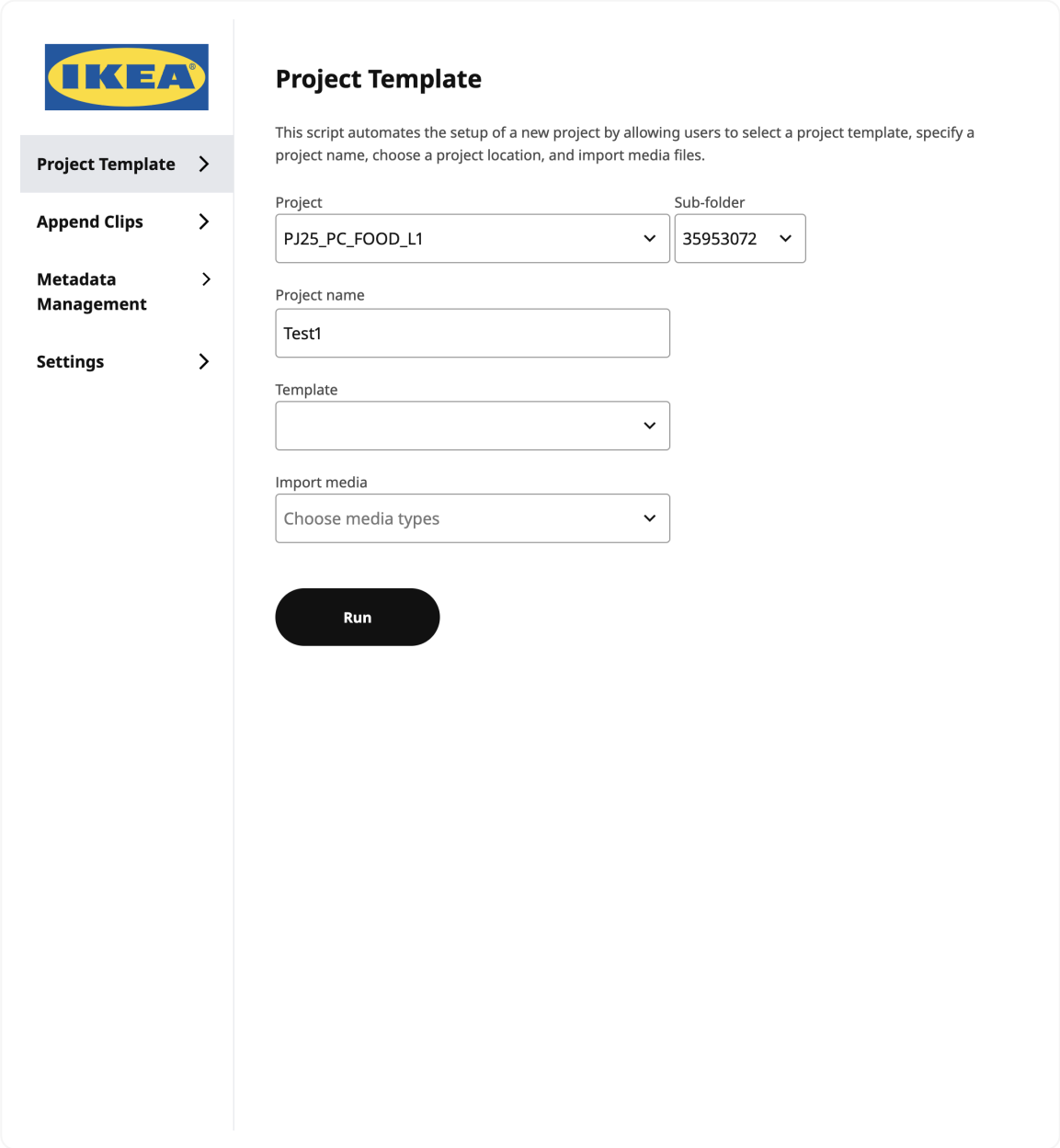
The Project Template tool helps you create new projects based on your pre-made templates, ensuring all your productions follow the same structure and standards.

**Step 1: Check Your Project Location**

Have a quick look to make sure the project location shown is correct. If it's not quite right, pop over to the Settings page to update it.

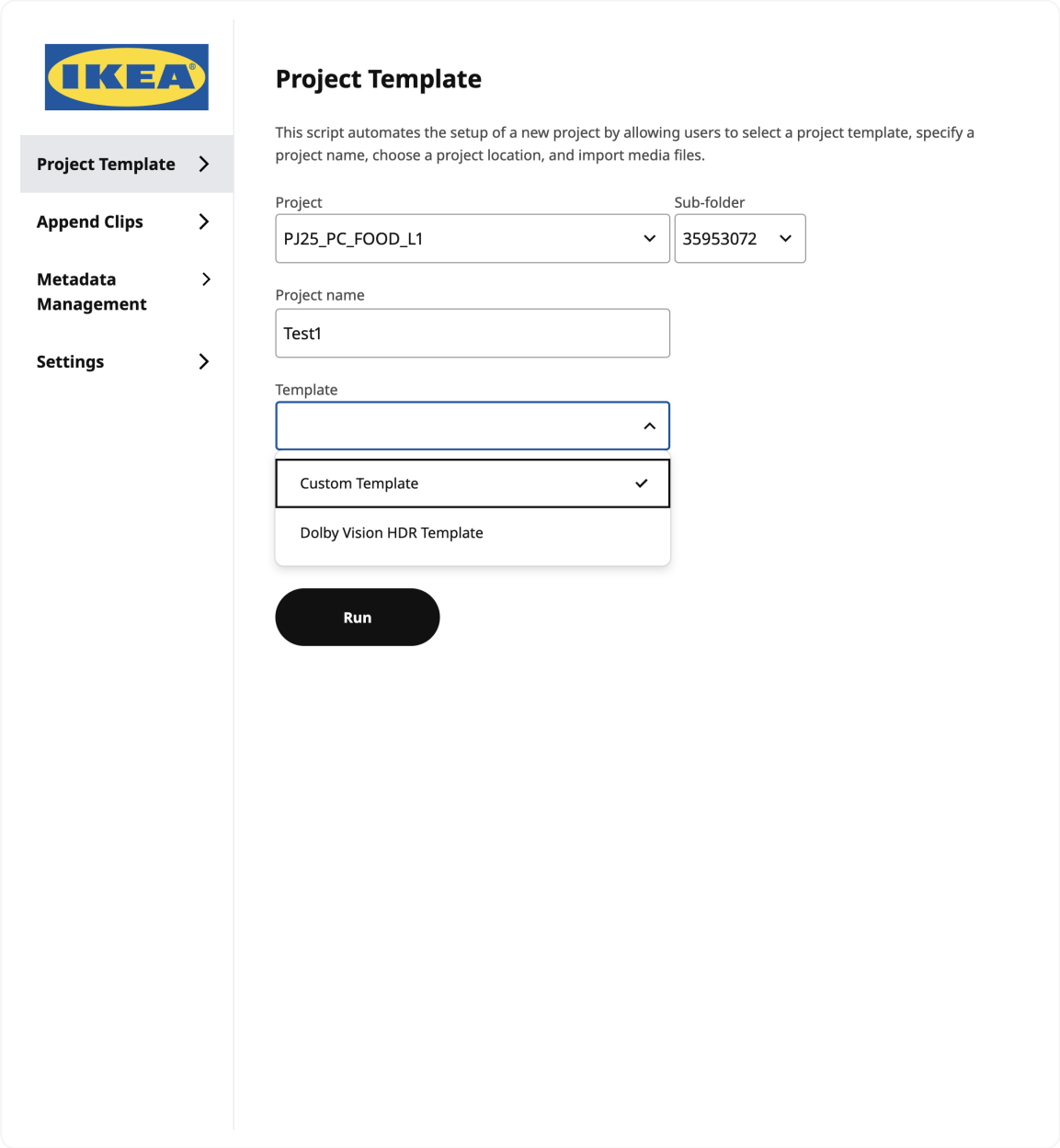
**Step 2: Name Your Project**

Give your new project a name. We'll use this for both the folder structure and the DaVinci Resolve project file.



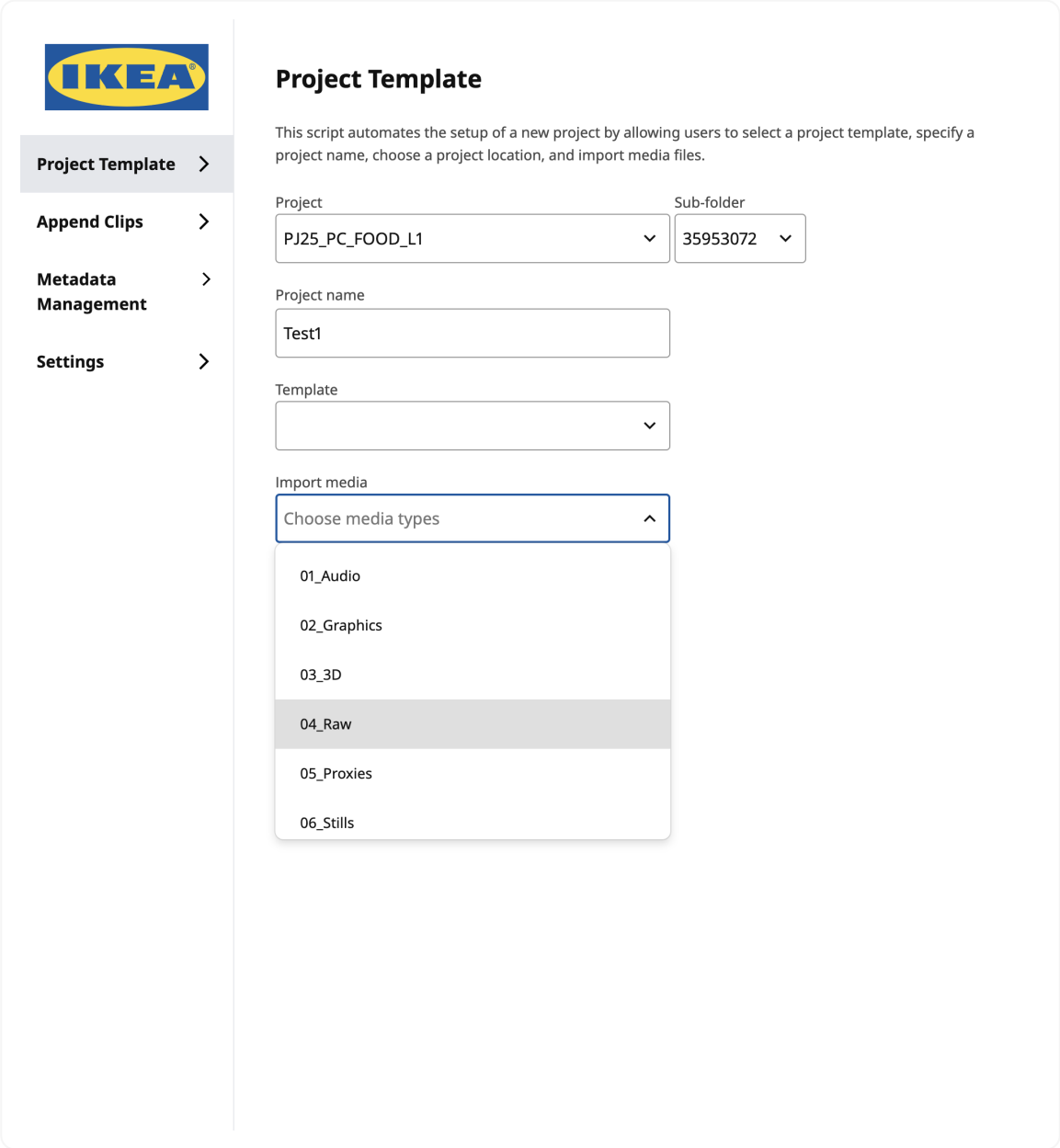

## Step 3: Pick a Template

Choose from the available templates in the dropdown menu. These come from your DaVinci Resolve template locations and any custom folders you've set up.




## Step 4: Select Media Types

Tick the types of media you'll be working with in this project. This helps organise your media bins according to your template structure.




## Step 5: Click Run

Hit the "Run" button and watch the magic happen. The app will:

- Imports and organises all media files into relevant bins
- Set up a new DaVinci Resolve project based on your chosen template

- Save a copy of the project file where you can easily find it later

DaVinci Resolve will open your new project and automatically save a copy of the project file (e.g., your_new_project.drp) to this folder for easy access:

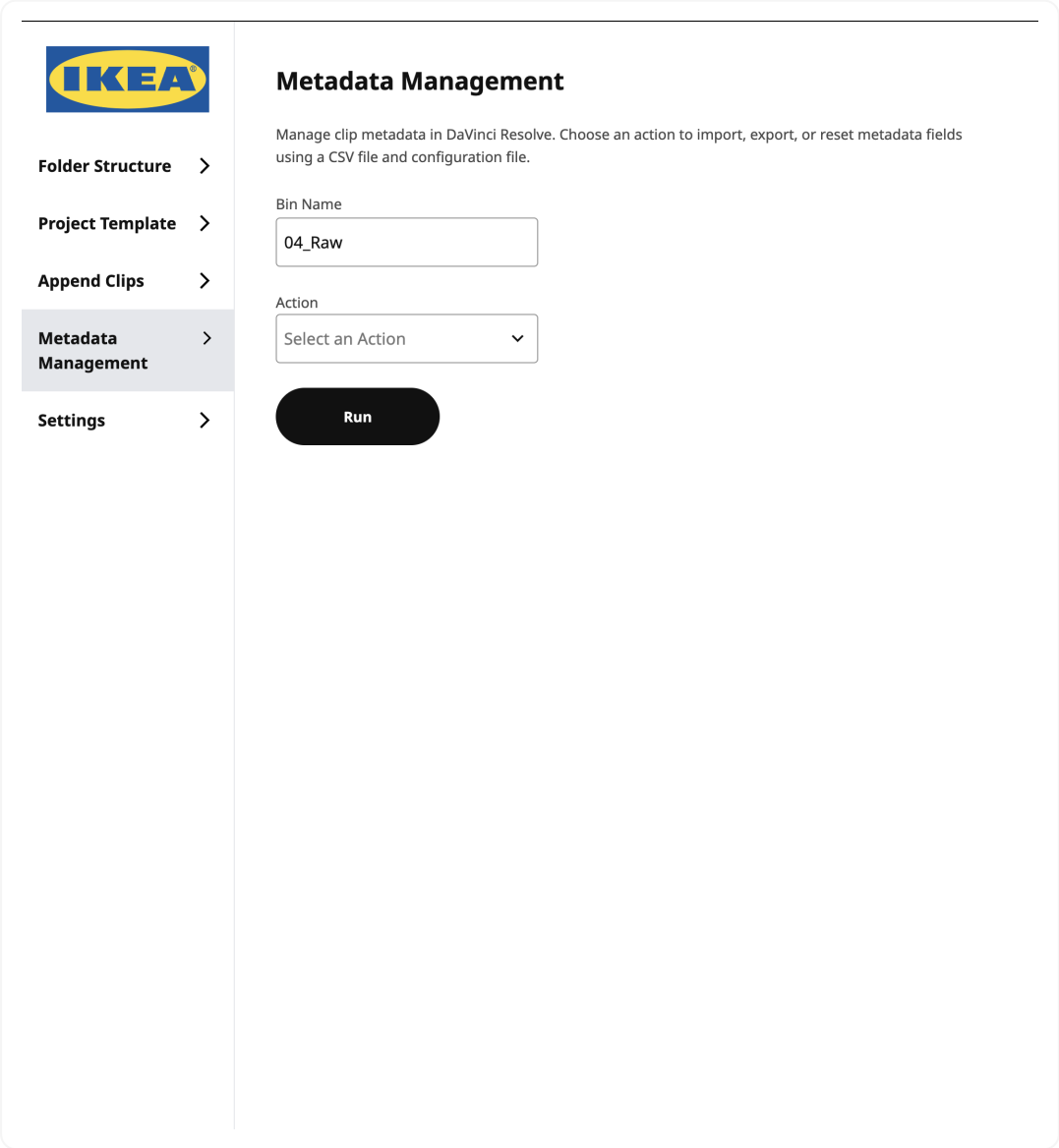
/Users/[your-username]/ProjectName/03_Offline_Edit/01_Projects/drp/your_new_project.drp

# 5. Metadata Management

Our Metadata Management tool lets you import, export, and organise metadata for clips in your DaVinci Resolve projects without the tedious manual work.

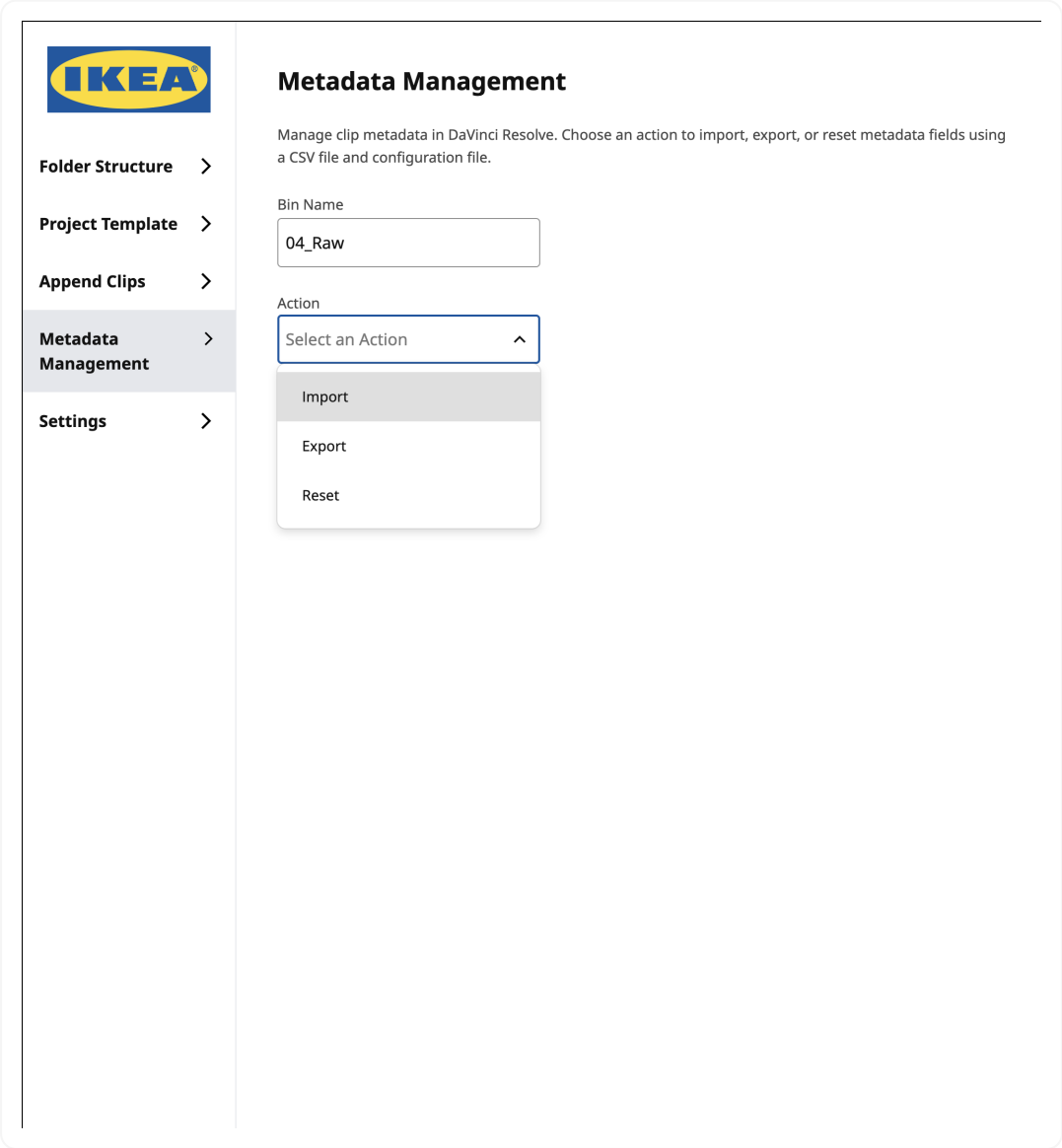
**Step 1: Choose Your Bin**

Select the bin containing the clips whose metadata you want to work with.



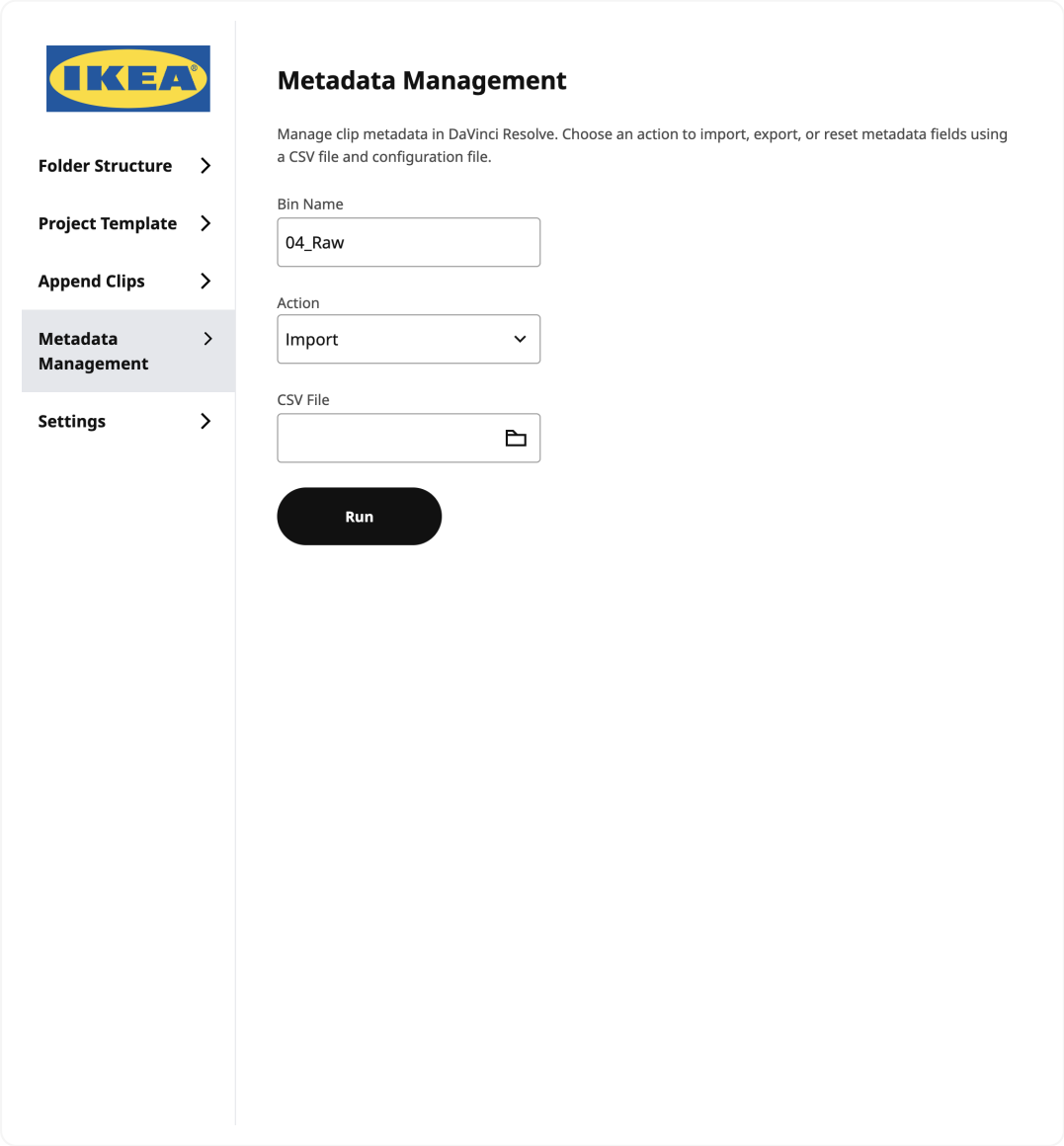

## Step 2: Choose Operation Type

Select whether you want to import metadata from a CSV file or export your existing metadata to a CSV file for editing elsewhere.




## Step 3: Select Your CSV File

If you're importing, navigate to the CSV file with your metadata. If you're exporting, the CSV file will be automatically saved to your Desktop with a timestamped filename.




## Step 4: Reset Metadata (Optional)

If you're importing metadata and want to start fresh, select the "Reset Metadata" option. This clears all existing metadata from your clips before adding the new information.

**Step 5: Run Operation**

Click the "Run" button to start the metadata operation.

**Note:** To customise which metadata fields are available, edit the metadata_fields.json file in the app's configuration folder. This allows you to tailor the tool to your specific workflow needs.

```
[
    "Description",
    "Comments",
    "Keywords",
    "Scene",
    "Shot",
    "Take",
    "Angle",
    "People",
    "Clip Color",
    "Move",
    "Day / Night",
    "End Timecode",
    "Environment",
    "Shot Type",
    "Flags",
    "Good Take",
    "Shoot Day",
    "Date Recorded",
    "Camera #",
    "Roll Card #",
    "Reel Number",
    "Clip Number",
    "Program Name",
    "Episode #",
    "Episode Name",
    "Shot During Ep",
    "Location",
    "Unit Name",
    "Setup"
]
```

# 6. Append Clips to Timeline

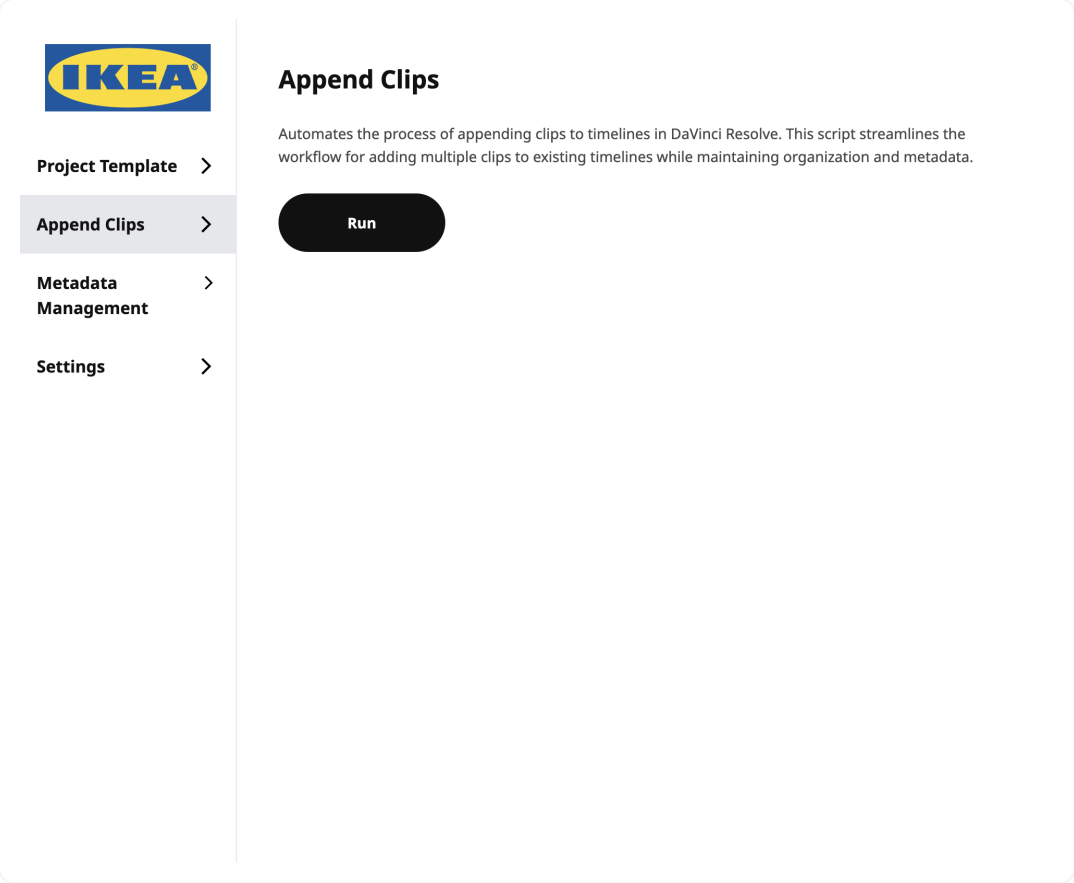
The Append Clips tool automatically creates a timeline from clips in your Media Pool, saving you hours of manual timeline assembly work.

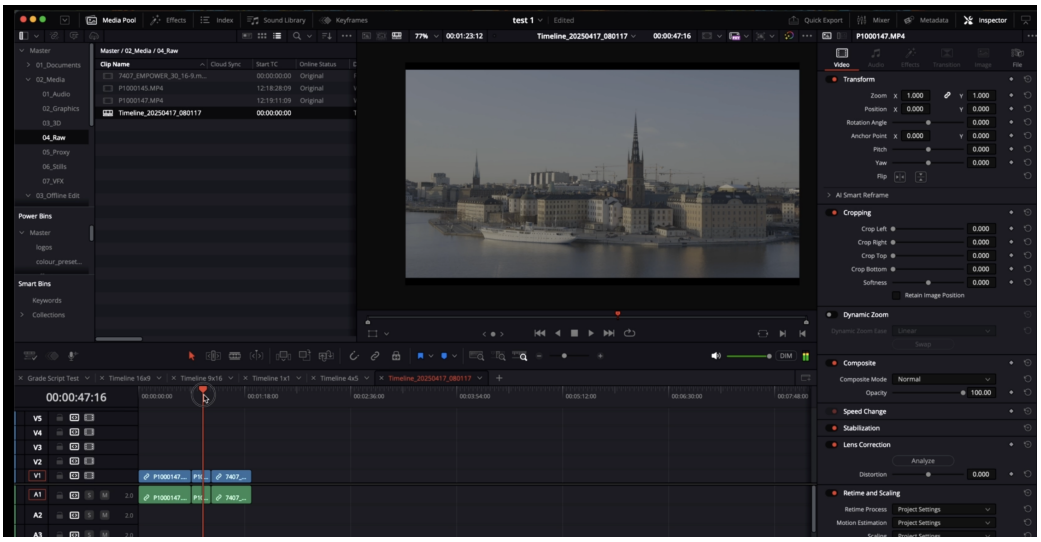
> **Step 1: Verify Media Files**
>
> Ensure your media files are organised in the bin you want to use (by default, the tool uses the '04_Raw' bin). The tool will create a timeline containing all clips from this bin.

> **Step 2: Run Operation**
>
> Click the "Run" button to create your timestamped timeline. The tool will automatically generate a timeline with all clips from the selected bin.

> **Note:** By default, the timeline will be created and saved to the '04_Raw' bin, following the project templates structure. If you want the created timeline

> to be saved in another bin in the DaVinci Resolve project, navigate to that bin and then click Run.



# 7. Script Descriptions

## Project Templates

Our Project Templates script takes the hassle out of setting up new projects by automating the creation of folder structures and DaVinci Resolve project files.

What it does for you:

- Creates a complete, organised folder structure at your chosen project location
- Finds templates from various locations including our bundled templates, your DaVinci Resolve templates, and any custom locations you've specified
- Sets up a new DaVinci Resolve project based on your selected template
- Saves a copy of the project file to a designated folder so you can easily find it later

## Metadata Management

Our Metadata Management script makes handling clip information a breeze, saving you from tedious manual data entry.

What it does for you:

- Brings metadata from CSV files directly into your DaVinci Resolve clip attributes
- Exports your existing clip metadata to CSV files for easy editing in spreadsheet applications
- Lets you map custom metadata fields through simple configuration files
- Offers a reset option to clear existing metadata before importing new information
- Works with clips in any bin within your current project

## Append Clips

Our Append Clips script saves you hours of timeline assembly by automating the process of adding multiple clips in sequence.

What it does for you:

- Grabs clips from your chosen bin in the Media Pool
- Adds them to your timeline in order, either creating a new timeline or using an existing one
- Can be run multiple times
- Preserves all your clip metadata and timeline settings during the process

# 8. Prerequisites & Requirements

## System Requirements

- macOS 10.15 or later / Windows 10 or later
- DaVinci Resolve 19 or later
- 8GB RAM minimum (16GB or higher recommended)
- 500MB free disk space

## Software Dependencies

- Python 3.6 or later (included with the application)
- DaVinci Resolve Studio (for full API support)

> While the free version of DaVinci Resolve works with some features, you'll get the best experience with DaVinci Resolve Studio, which offers full scripting capabilities.

# 9. Troubleshooting

## Common Issues

### DaVinci Resolve Connection Problems

> **Problem:** The app can't connect to DaVinci Resolve.
>
> **Solution:**
>
> - Make sure DaVinci Resolve is running before you start using the app
> - Check that you're using a compatible version of DaVinci Resolve (version 19 or later)
> - Try restarting both DaVinci Resolve and the app

### Missing Templates

> **Problem:** The app can't find your templates.
>
> **Solution:**
>
> - Check that your templates are saved in one of the standard locations

- If you're using custom templates, double-check the path in Settings
- Make sure your templates are in the correct format (.drp files)

### macOS Specific Issues

**Problem:** You get security warnings when launching the app.

**Solution:**

- Right-click the app and select "Open" the first time you run it
- In System Preferences > Security & Privacy, allow the app to run

### Windows Specific Issues

**Problem:** Script execution policy is blocking the app.

**Solution:**

- Run PowerShell as Administrator and type: `Set-ExecutionPolicy -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -Scope Process`
- When Windows Defender prompts you, allow the app to run

# 10. Recommended Workflow

For the best experience with the Auto-Motion App, we recommend following this workflow:

1. Set up your paths in Settings
2. Create a new project using Project Templates
3. Import and organise your media
4. Use Metadata Management to add information to your clips
5. Use Append Clips to quickly assemble rough cuts or dailies

# 11. Support Team

## IT Support

If you run into technical issues with the application:

- Email: it-support@inter.ikea.com (TBD)

- Phone: Internal extension 12345 (TBD)

## Workflow Support

For questions about post-production workflow:

- Contact: Samuel Smith
- Email: samuel.smith3@inter.ikea.com

## Auto-Motion App Support

For questions about app troubleshooting:

- Contact: Nicolo Ridulfo
- Email: nicolo.ridulfo1@inter.ikea.com
- Contact: Samuel Smith
- Email: samuel.smith3@inter.ikea.com

## Feedback

We'd love to hear your thoughts on how we can make the app even better:

**Please provide your feedback using this link:**

https://forms.cloud.microsoft/Pages/ResponsePage.aspx?id=xGo8oy6lxUWvB7ly35vQBGjMzUvVI9VErsI7-pn61_dUQUhYM1FJUldYUTk2WkxJOUlQOEZZU1JIRS4u

**Future Features:**

- Use the Feedback feature in the app
- Email your suggestions to: app-feedback@inter.ikea.com (TBD)

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